

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | SIEM Architecture | Incident Response | Cloud Security | SOAR Automation

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience leading security operations, advanced incident investigations, and threat hunting across complex enterprise environments. I have deep operational knowledge of Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) architecture and advanced query development using Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel, and I am experienced in building and operating Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms to streamline investigation workflows and reduce mean time to respond. I have a strong background in cloud-native security across Microsoft Azure and the Microsoft 365 ecosystem, and I am practised in escalating and coordinating complex, multi-stakeholder security incidents with clarity and precision. I work effectively as a senior escalation resource for L2 analysts, mentoring junior team members while leading high-impact investigations and contributing to tooling proof of concept projects and platform improvements.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Architecture and Advanced Querying:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL - advanced rule authoring, detection engineering, hunting queries, and operational dashboarding
- **SOAR Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps), automated alert triage, investigation orchestration, and response workflow engineering
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert; alert triage, threat investigation, detection policy tuning
- **Cloud-Native Security:** Microsoft Azure security services, Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Azure cloud security monitoring and investigation
- **OS Internals and Security Architecture:** Windows (Active Directory, Group Policy, registry forensics), macOS, and Linux endpoint security
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Incident Response:** L3 escalation and investigation lead; NIST SP 800-61 framework; MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTP) mapping and threat hunting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast gateway management, phishing investigation, Business Email Compromise (BEC) response
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security automation and response
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Act as the senior escalation point for complex security events, performing timely and thorough L3 investigations of escalated incidents involving endpoint compromise, identity attacks, phishing campaigns, and data loss scenarios, and driving each case to containment and remediation
- Develop and maintain advanced Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection rules and threat hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), continuously refining logic to improve signal fidelity and reduce false positives
- Build and operate Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert enrichment, analyst notification, and initial response actions to accelerate mean time to respond (MTTR) across a range of incident types

- Lead advanced threat hunting activities using CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Insight, Discover) and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively searching for indicators of compromise and Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Investigate and respond to cloud-native security incidents across Microsoft Azure and the Microsoft 365 ecosystem, including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender
- Manage Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) security configurations including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO), and investigate identity-based threats such as account compromise, privilege escalation, and lateral movement
- Liaise with platform and engineering teams to agree automation improvements and tooling enhancements, contributing to proof of concept evaluations for new security technologies
- Coordinate high-profile security incidents requiring cross-functional engagement, liaising directly with affected business units, IT service owners, and senior leadership to ensure clear communication and rapid resolution
- Conduct OS internals-level forensic investigation across Windows, macOS, and Linux endpoints, including process analysis, memory artefact review, and log correlation to reconstruct attack timelines
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations, supporting a culture of security consciousness across the organisation
- Produce post-incident reports and lessons-learned documentation for technical and non-technical audiences, distilling complex security events into clear, actionable summaries

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alert triage and investigation in Microsoft Sentinel, developing KQL queries to detect and investigate anomalous behaviour across endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces
- Escalated and investigated L2 security events, conducting structured analysis of suspicious activity and documenting findings with clear remediation recommendations
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform management, including policy configuration, exclusions management, and threat investigation workflows
- Delivered Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert enrichment and improving analyst efficiency
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) alerting, investigating and remediating endpoint and identity threats
- Administered Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) and contributed to the rollout of Conditional Access policies and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) as part of a zero-trust identity programme
- Conducted vulnerability management activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, assisting with scanning, risk-rated reporting, and remediation coordination
- Produced security metrics dashboards and executive-level reporting, translating technical security data into clear risk summaries for senior stakeholders

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security operations in a Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech environment, including patch management, endpoint security configuration, and access management controls
- Monitored network and endpoint security events, escalating potential incidents and supporting initial triage and investigation activities
- Contributed to infrastructure quality assurance and compliance activities, assisting with internal audit preparation and security control assessments
- Managed identity and access management processes including Joiner-Mover-Leaver (JML) workflows, applying least-privilege principles across corporate systems

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered an advanced Microsoft Sentinel Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook suite that automated phishing triage and alert enrichment, reducing mean time to respond

(MTTR) for email-borne threats and freeing analyst capacity for complex L3 investigations

- Led the deployment and operational optimisation of CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across 8,000 endpoints, creating custom detection policies aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework that measurably improved threat detection capability
- Built a library of advanced KQL threat hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel enabling proactive detection of credential-based attacks, lateral movement, and data exfiltration patterns across cloud and on-premises environments
- Delivered the enterprise-wide implementation of Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Conditional Access, significantly strengthening the identity security posture for more than 8,000 users
- Managed Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)-led vulnerability programmes, translating simulation findings into prioritised remediation plans that reduced the organisation's critical and high-severity vulnerability exposure

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)